

MARKET RESEARCH INTERNSHIP · SEPTEMBER 2026

568 companies.
Six weeks.
One market, mapped.

157

confirmed diesel users

72

leads generated by us

20

companies left a rival

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Eight numbers that describe six weeks.

Every figure is derived directly from the field workbook. No external data has been added.

Figure	What it is	Figure	What it is
568	companies visited, from 651 field visits	20	companies named CAFU unprompted, 16 of them negatively
157	confirmed diesel users, 27.6% of the book	60%	of measured volume sits in Cold companies, excluding one outlier account
194	more companies blocked or unresolved, not rejected	23	Hot leads who asked for a quote, sample or visit
72	leads we generated ourselves, 70.8% of them green	117	closed records caused by a wrong address, not absent demand

The uncomfortable one is 60%. The average Cold company uses 2.4 times the diesel of a Hot one.

Find out who buys diesel in the UAE, and how.

	Objective	What that meant in practice
01	Map the market	Identify businesses that consume diesel across the UAE and record how much they use.
02	Understand how they buy	Current supplier, pain points, decision maker and buying behaviour.
03	Map the competition	Who serves this market today, and where the gaps are.
04	Build awareness	Introduce FILLIT to businesses that had never heard of the name.

FILLIT delivers diesel on demand across the UAE, from 100 litres to 5 million, at a certified 10ppm specification, with GPS tracking and 24/7 dispatch. Its buyers are fleet and plant managers, site and project managers, marine operators and procurement leads.

Three days at a desk, then six weeks on the road.

We began with desk research and cold calls for the first three days only, then moved entirely to in-person field visits.

Phase	What we did	What it told us
First 3 days	Desk research. Company websites, LinkedIn pages and trade directories to build a picture of who burns diesel in the UAE.	Gave us a starting prospect list and a working vocabulary for the industry.
First 3 days	Cold calls. Phone outreach to test the pitch and learn the objections before going door to door.	Taught us which questions actually get answered on a first contact
Weeks 1 to 6	651 in-person field visits. Turn up unannounced, ask reception for the fuel buyer, run the same five questions, log it the same day.	Produced the entire dataset behind this presentation.

The five questions, every time: Who supplies you today? · How much do you use? · What burns it? · What goes wrong? · Who decides?

Week 1 in the field returned a 59.5% dead-end rate. That told us the list was the problem, so we started building our own.

568 companies, every one classified.

651 field visits resolved to 568 unique companies. Each is shown at its latest status; where colour and written interest level differed, interest level was used.

Status	Companies	Share	What it means
Hot	23	4.0%	Using diesel, high intent. Asked for a quote, sample or visit.
Warm	39	6.9%	Using diesel, interested, needs a follow-up.
Cold	95	16.7%	Confirmed diesel user, not ready to switch. A nurture list.
Appointment	90	15.8%	Could not get in. Free zone, permit or gate pass needed.
Revisit	104	18.3%	Unresolved. The process stopped, the company did not.
Invalid	217	38.2%	Disqualified. Mostly a wrong address rather than no demand.
Total	568	100%	157 confirmed diesel users. 194 more blocked or unresolved.

The addressable pool is not 157. Another 194 companies are blocked or unresolved, not rejected.

Our targets, and what each number means.

Set at the start of the internship. A plain English definition sits beside every figure.

KPI area	Measure	Result	What it means
Outreach volume	Companies contacted	568	Separate businesses reached. Each counted once.
	Field visits made	651	Total visits, including return trips.
	Emirates covered	4	Dubai, Sharjah, Ajman and Umm Al Quwain.
Lead quality	Confirmed diesel users	157	Companies that actually burn diesel. 27.6% of the book.
	Fuel buyers named	119	The person who decides, with contact details.
	New leads generated	72	Companies on no list. 70.8% of them turned green.
Standard of work	Companies classified	568	Every one given a final status. None left blank.
	Weeks delivered on time	6 of 6	Every weekly sheet consolidated on schedule.
	Dead-end rate, Week 1 to Week 4	59.5% to 18.8%	Fell by two thirds once we began generating our own leads.

72 new leads was a target in its own right, and those leads turned green 3.3 times more often.

Week 1 taught us to stop working the list.

Week 1 produced a 59.5% dead-end rate and no self-generated leads. From Week 2 it fell to as low as 18.8%.

Week	Visits	Hot	Warm	Cold	Green rate	Dead-end rate	New leads
Week 1	121	7	4	5	13.2%	59.5%	0
Week 2	120	4	15	26	37.5%	30.0%	15
Week 3	96	1	5	24	31.2%	30.2%	18
Week 4	96	4	6	16	27.1%	18.8%	19
Week 5	116	5	3	11	16.4%	19.8%	20
Week 6	102	2	6	14	21.6%	46.1%	0
Total	651	23	39	96	24.3%	34.6%	72

Weeks 2 to 5, when we generated our own leads, ran at 19% to 30% dead ends. Week 6 was mostly revisits and gated sites.

Every major pain point appears only beside a live lead.

Text-mined from the comments, pain points, fleet and supplier fields across all 568 companies. A company can raise more than one.

Pain point	Companies	Hot	Warm	Cold	Share green	Severity
Equipment, generator and forklift	66	14	19	27	91%	Major
Vehicles driven to a station	25	5	12	8	100%	Major
Price and rate	21	8	8	5	100%	Major
CAFU service failure	20	6	13	1	100%	Major
Delivery and on-site refuelling	18	4	11	1	89%	Major
Fuel quality and 10ppm spec	16	4	6	6	100%	Major
ADNOC / ENOC chip and prepaid friction	13	4	6	3	100%	Moderate
Credit and payment terms	9	4	5	0	100%	High value
Trust and vendor verification	5	1	3	0	80%	Moderate
Minimum order quantity	1	1	0	0	100%	Isolated

66 companies raised equipment, generator or forklift refuelling. Price, CAFU and fuel quality appear only beside companies that use diesel.

Who decides, how they buy, and what they told us.

Drawn from 651 field visits. Quotations are verbatim, original spelling retained.

How they buy	Evidence	What they said	Company
Fuel decision sits with a named buyer	119 named	"They used to take from Cafu, but cafu stopped delivering"	SHJ Carbon Factory, Hot
Usually procurement, accounts, operations or owner	By role	"Low quality fuel is reducing their vehicle's efficiency"	Uniforce Contracting, Hot
Locked into ADNOC / ENOC chip or prepaid cards	13 cos.	"ADNOC has minimum quantity requirement"	SCA Shipping, Hot
Buys from unverified independent traders	35 cos.	"Contract with CAFU in 2025 but they stole their credit"	Al Jalal Trading, Warm
Drives vehicles to a retail station	28 cos.	"No trust on door step delivery"	Main Crete Contracting, Warm
Asks for credit terms before switching	9 cos.	"Facing problems with ADNOC chip, need to topup"	Daira Carpentry, Warm

The common objections are reliability, quality, trust and access. Almost none are about price.

90 companies are blocked, not disqualified.

Free zone entry, appointment protocols and gate passes. All solvable with administration rather than more visits.

Barrier	Companies	What is actually needed
Inside a free zone	47	A registered free-zone access pass. JAFZA, Hamriyah and Dubai Industrial City.
Booked appointment required	43	A scheduled meeting rather than a walk-in. Mostly larger corporates.
Gate pass required	44	Site-level security clearance, usually arranged in advance by the client.
Of which: Jebel Ali / JAFZA	62	62 companies visited, 40 blocked at the gate, and zero Hot leads recorded.

A company can face more than one barrier, so the rows overlap. The workbook has a Passes Required field for this problem; it holds two entries against 90 blocked companies.

Buying access is cheaper than buying more field days.

Metals converted at 65%. Contracting took 37% of our visits and returned 23%.

Green rate means the share of companies confirmed as diesel users: Hot, Warm or Cold.

Industry	Visited	Hot	Warm	Cold	Green rate	New leads
Metal, steel and aluminium	20	5	4	4	65.0%	2
Food and beverage	20	2	4	3	45.0%	5
Auto workshop and equipment	18	1	1	6	44.4%	2
Trading	12	0	2	2	33.3%	0
Manufacturing and factory	48	4	4	7	31.2%	4
Plastics and packaging	23	0	2	5	30.4%	2
Marine, boats and shipping	63	2	5	9	25.4%	19
Building and civil contracting	209	7	9	32	23.0%	17
Electro-mechanical and MEP	5	0	0	1	20.0%	0
Transport, logistics and fleet	59	1	2	6	15.3%	3
Healthcare	14	0	0	2	14.3%	0
Other / unclassified	77	1	6	18	32.5%	18

Marine and boat building is the sleeper: 63 companies, and 19 of our 72 self-generated leads came from it.

Al Sajaa returned 84.6% green. Jebel Ali returned no Hot leads at all.

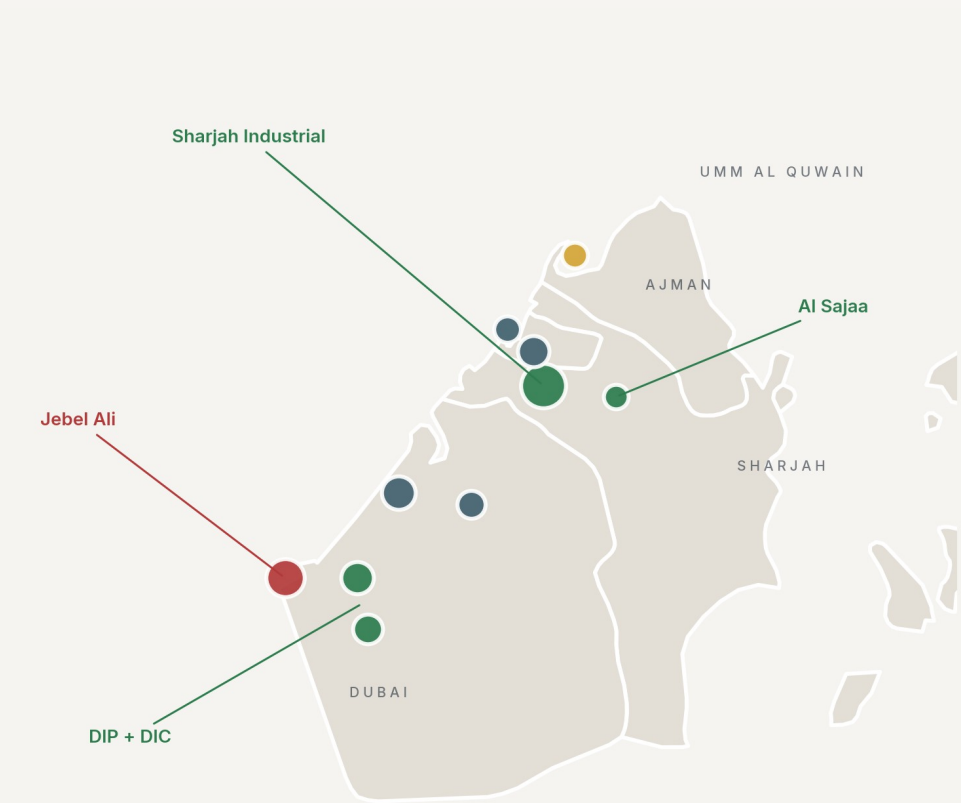
Jebel Ali is not a demand problem. 40 of its 62 companies were blocked at the gate.

Area	Companies visited	Green rate	Visits per Hot lead
Al Sajaa, Sharjah	13	84.6%	13 visits
Warsan / International City	9	66.7%	no Hot leads
Dubai Industrial City	26	50.0%	9 visits
Nadd Al Hamar	6	50.0%	no Hot leads
Dubai Investment Park	32	46.9%	16 visits
Al Jurf, Ajman	16	37.5%	16 visits
Sharjah Industrial Areas	51	35.3%	13 visits
Dubai Silicon Oasis	19	26.3%	no Hot leads
Umm Al Quwain	16	25.0%	16 visits
Al Quoz	45	22.2%	45 visits
Business Bay / Jumeirah / Barsha	83	21.7%	42 visits
Ajman Industrial Area	56	21.4%	28 visits
Jebel Ali / JAFZA	62	17.7%	no Hot leads

Dubai Industrial City and DIP together: 58 companies at 48% green, and 16 self-generated leads.

Four territories to work, one to stop visiting.

Only the areas we actually covered are shown. Abu Dhabi and Ras Al Khaimah were not part of this programme.



	Territory	Why
1	Sharjah Industrial Areas + Al Sajaa	64 companies at 35.3% and 84.6% green. Street by street sweep.
2	Dubai Investment Park + Dubai Industrial City	58 companies at 48% green, and 16 self-generated leads.
3	Jebel Ali / JAFZA	62 companies, 40 blocked at the gate. Needs passes, not visits.
4	Al Jurf + Ajman Industrial	72 companies. Worth a second sweep with verified addresses.
Stop	Business Bay, Jumeirah, Silicon Oasis	102 companies returned 23 green and 2 Hot. Registered offices, not sites.

No supplier owns this market, and CAFU has created a vacuum.

Of the 102 companies that named a supplier, the largest single group buys from independent traders.

Current supplier	Companies	Hot	Warm	Cold	What their customers say
Independent third-party traders	35	10	9	14	Quality and trust complaints cluster here.
ADNOC	29	6	14	9	Price, contract difficulty, minimum quantities.
Self-fuelling at retail stations	28	3	15	10	Not a supplier relationship at all. The competitor is the pump.
ENOC / EPPCO	27	3	11	12	Price.
CAFU	20 mentioned	2	3	0	Withdrawal and service failure. 16 of 20 mentions are negative.
Emarat	1	-	-	-	Marginal presence in this dataset.

Pricing context: UAE diesel is price-regulated at AED 4.30 per litre (September 2026), so every station charges the same. CAFU reinstated delivery fees of AED 12 to 20 per order in April 2025. FILLIT's differentiators are therefore delivery, 10ppm quality, no minimum order and pricing issued before dispatch, not the litre price.

28 companies have no delivered-fuel supplier at all. They drive to a station. The competitor is the pump.

Our own scoring was pointing at the wrong companies.

Across the 75 Hot, Warm and Cold companies whose consumption converts to litres per month, excluding one outlier account.

60%

of measured diesel volume sits in companies we scored Cold.

RP Group (Hot, about 4.5 million litres a month) is excluded because it alone would outweigh everything else combined.

Measure	Hot	Warm	Cold
Companies with measured volume	17	30	28
Total litres per month	193,531	317,881	770,688
Share of measured volume	15.1%	24.8%	60.1%
Average per company	11,384 L	10,596 L	27,525 L

Escalate the top 10 Cold accounts by volume to a named account manager. The average Cold company uses 2.4x a Hot one.

Six customer problems, and the opening each one creates.

Each row is a named group of companies in the handover files, not a market segment estimate.

Customer problem	Companies	The commercial opening it creates
CAFU stopped delivering or will not fill on site	20	Direct replacement of a withdrawn supplier. No price fight required.
Vehicles and machinery driven to a fuel station	25	Sell downtime recovery, not a cheaper litre. Price is regulated, time is not.
Bad fuel from independent traders	16	Verifiable 10ppm with batch certification. Nine of ten quality specs asked for 10ppm.
ADNOC minimum quantities and chip friction	13	No-minimum delivery and post-paid terms. The exclusion is itself a market.
Credit and working capital	9	Structured terms. Four of the nine credit requests are already Hot.
Forklift, generator and machinery refuelling	66	The largest group of all. None of this equipment can be driven to a pump.

Not one of these six openings is a price argument.

62 qualified companies, named and profiled.

Seven of each shown. Every one has a named contact, a known current supplier and a recorded fleet.

23 Hot leads	Area	Buys from today
RP Group, Gulf Asian Contracting	Ajman	Multiple 3rd party traders
Merint Interior	Dubai Industrial City	ENOC (chip)
Sun Metal Casting Factory	Sharjah Industrial	Third party
Al Fanous Al Fadhi Glass	Al Sajaa	Drives to fuel station
MGM General Contracting	Dubai	Maxwell Fuel Trading
Bilal Industries	Ajman	Local vendor
Menders Contracting	Dubai	Third party

39 Warm leads	Area	Buys from today
Bin Yaber Driving Institute	Dubai	ENOC
Emcon Contracting	Al Quoz	Station and 3rd party
Al Shamsi Boat Factory	Ajman	Ajwa Diesel Trading
Dayal Metal Containers	Ajman	ADNOC (chip)
Coca-Cola Al Ahila Beverage	Umm Al Quwain	ADNOC (chip)
Al Jalal Trading	Al Sajaa	ADNOC (prepaid)
Al Basma Detergents	Sharjah	Drives to fuel station

Full lists for Hot, Warm, Cold, self-generated leads and CAFU-affected accounts are handed over as separate Excel files with this deck.

Seven of these fourteen drive to a pump or buy from an unverified trader. Each is a direct switching opportunity.

The leads we found ourselves beat the list on every measure.

72 companies identified by walking in, logged in the New Leads section, against the 496 companies from the planned list.

Lead source	Companies	Green	Green rate	Dead ends	Dead-end rate
Self-generated in the field	72	51	70.8%	10	13.9%
The planned prospect list	496	106	21.4%	207	41.7%

What that difference means
3.3x better green rate than the prospect list we were handed.
3x lower dead-end rate, because we chose the address ourselves rather than trusting a stale list.
19 of the 72 came from marine and boat building alone, a sector nobody had targeted.
Week 1 generated zero new leads and a 59.5% dead-end rate. That is the whole argument.
Self-generated leads carry the largest accounts in the entire book, including RP Group.

Top five findings.

	Finding	The evidence
01	Our own lead scoring points at the wrong companies	Excluding one outlier, 60% of measured volume sits in Cold. The average Cold company uses 27,525 L a month, 2.4x a Hot one.
02	CAFU has created a vacuum worth taking now	20 companies mentioned CAFU unprompted, 16 negatively. All 20 are confirmed diesel users.
03	Most closed records failed on addresses, not demand	117 of 217 invalid records say the company was not at the address. Only 51 say there is no diesel requirement.
04	The leads we generated beat the list 3.3 to 1	72 self-generated leads returned 70.8% green and 13.9% dead. The planned list returned 21.4% and 41.7%.
05	90 companies are blocked, not disqualified	47 sit in free zones. Jebel Ali alone is 62 companies, 40 blocked at the gate, and zero Hot leads.

Top five recommendations.

	Recommendation	Why	Expected effect
01	Send quotations to all 23 Hot leads this week	Every Hot lead asked for a quote, sample or visit, and each has a named contact on file.	Revenue within 30 days
02	Run a named CAFU-replacement campaign	20 identified accounts that mentioned CAFU, 16 of them negatively.	Warmest segment in the book
03	Escalate the top 10 Cold accounts by volume	Cold holds 60% of measured litres, excluding one outlier. Give them an account manager.	The litres are here
04	Sell downtime recovery, not cheaper fuel	28 companies drive vehicles to a station. Price is regulated; time is not.	Reframes the pitch
05	Buy free-zone access, then work Jebel Ali	90 companies blocked. 47 sit inside free zones. One administrative fix.	90 companies unlocked

Ready to implement, and what it is worth.

Ready to implement this week	What it uses	Expected business impact
Quote pack for the 23 Hot leads	Contacts and suppliers already on file.	23 open requests converted into live conversations.
CAFU switch offer for 20 accounts	One page: same fuel, on site, invoice before dispatch.	20 accounts available without a price fight.
Forklift and generator refuelling offer	A need no station network can serve.	A proposition competitors structurally cannot copy.
Free-zone access applications	JAFZA, Hamriyah and Dubai Industrial City.	90 blocked companies unlocked by admin, not visits.
Split the Red bucket in two	No diesel demand versus bad address.	117 closed records recoverable by verifying the address.
Account-manage the top 10 Cold	Ranked by measured monthly litres.	Re-prioritises 60% of measured volume.

None of this needs new headcount. Every item uses data already collected and handed over.

The three-month action plan, and months four to six.

Built for the commercial team, not the research team. Every action traces back to a finding.

Window	Theme	Actions	Owner
Days 1 to 30	Convert what is already asking	Send quotations to the 23 Hot leads. Launch the CAFU switch campaign across 20 accounts. Publish LinkedIn Weeks 1 and 2, creative is designed and ready.	Sales + Marketing
Days 31 to 60	Go where the litres are	Account-manage the top 10 Cold accounts, which hold 60% of measured volume. Sweep Sharjah Industrial and Al Sajaa, 64 companies. Secure free-zone access for 90 blocked companies.	Sales + Operations
Days 61 to 90	Build the repeatable engine	Launch the forklift and generator offer. Publish the UAE diesel procurement report to generate inbound. Move 568 records into a CRM with outcome tracking so conversion becomes measurable.	Marketing + Data
Months 4 to 6	Scale what worked	Track quote-to-order conversion by territory and sector. Re-run field research in Hamriyah and Umm Al Quwain. Target 1,000+ LinkedIn followers from about 350 today.	Leadership

157 confirmed diesel users, 23 Hot leads asking for a quote, 20 leaving a competitor. The demand is identified and named.

A four-week LinkedIn plan, written post by post.

28 posts, all 10 content pillars, 13 formats. Week 1 creative is designed and ready. Built on this field research.

Week	Objective	Posts written	Status
Week 1	Frame the problem	Poll on the biggest refuelling bottleneck. Carousel on dead mileage and idle wages. Generator damage post. White paper launch with a comment-gated CTA.	Creative complete, 10 images
Week 2	Prove the difference	10ppm against standard fuel in a Euro 5/6 engine. Night refuelling carousel. Fuel as a service. The drivers behind the deliveries.	Full copy written
Week 3	Show the system	Free dead-mileage and ROI audit for 10 fleets. Paper logbooks post. The five-step delivery workflow. The eight-point continuity checklist.	Full copy written
Week 4	Convert	Resilience by design. 100 litres to 5 million. Emergency top-ups. The dispatch team. One month on from the white paper.	Full copy written

Engagement rules that shaped it: links go in the first comment, never the post body · comment-gated CTAs beat link clicks · thought leadership publishes from the founder profile · LinkedIn does not expose poll voters, so follow up with commenters

Tasks, challenges, and the tools we used.

Tasks assigned	Challenge	How we addressed it	Tools and platforms
Visit businesses across Dubai, Sharjah, Ajman and UAQ	59.5% dead ends in Week 1	Stopped relying on the list and generated our own leads	Microsoft Excel
Identify diesel users and their current supplier	Wrong or outdated addresses	Recorded the reason, so 117 are recoverable	Python and pandas
Record volume, fleet, pain points, decision maker	Free zones and gate passes	Logged 90 as blocked, not disqualified	Google Maps
Introduce FILLIT and distribute flyers	Reception gatekeepers	Asked specifically for the fuel buyer by role	LinkedIn
Log and classify every visit in the weekly workbook	Inconsistent consumption units	Converted litres, gallons and AED to one measure	WhatsApp
Generate new leads beyond the supplied list	Colour and written status differed	Used the written interest level for 26 records	PowerPoint

Each challenge became a finding. The Week 1 dead-end rate is what produced the 72 self-generated leads.

My contribution, what I learned, and what I am handing over.

My individual contribution	Files and assets handed over
Field visits and decision-maker interviews across Dubai, Sharjah, Ajman and Umm Al Quwain	Master company database. 568 companies, latest status, fully classified
Designed the 23-field capture schema and the colour-coded status system used by the whole team	Hot, Warm and Cold lead files. Separate Excel workbooks with contacts and volumes
Built and maintained the consolidated database, including de-duplication and weekly consolidation	Self-generated leads file. The 72 companies we found ourselves
Ran the full analysis: funnel, area, industry, supplier, pain-point and lead-source	CAFU-affected accounts. 20 companies with their verbatim notes
Authored the LinkedIn content and engagement strategy and the 2026 white paper	Interactive dashboard. Filterable, with drill-down to any single company
Built the interactive lead dashboard handed over with this presentation	LinkedIn strategy and 2026 white paper. 4-week plan, 28 posts, Week 1 creative complete
Team: Mudar, Gautham, Parasharan and Divesh shared field visits, client conversations, flyers and data logging equally	
Key learnings from the internship	
Lead scoring measures willingness to talk, not commercial value. The two ran in opposite directions here.	
Data quality is a commercial variable. 117 companies were lost to addresses, not to absent demand.	
The leads you find yourself beat any list you are handed, by 3.3 to 1 on green rate.	

Sources and references.

Source	Used for
Combined_week1-week5.xlsx and Combined_week6.xlsx, 7 Aug to 17 Sep 2026 (main source)	Every count, rate, area, industry, supplier, volume and quotation in this deck
Vision Crafter Diesel Field Research Report	Analytical approach and qualitative framing only; figures re-verified against the main sheets
UAE Fuel Price Committee, via Gulf News and Khaleej Times, Sept 2026	Diesel retail price of AED 4.30 per litre
Gulf News, 24 April 2025	CAFU reinstating delivery fees of AED 12 to 20
The National, 23 January 2026	CAFU slot-availability and supply problems
FILLIT official flyer and fillit.co	FILLIT service claims: 10ppm, 100 L to 5M L, 24/7, GPS tracking
LinkedIn pages of DP World, ENOC, Transguard, G42, Masdar, Mubadala, Gartner and others	B2B content benchmark behind the LinkedIn strategy